About the Author

William "Bill" Ersthaler was born in 1924, lived in Detroit before the war. He enlisted in 1943, one month before he was scheduled to be drafted. At age 19 he went through Army boot camp and continued onto flight school. In 1944 he joined the 22nd Bomber Group as a navigator and later deployed to the Western Pacific. As a navigator of the B-24, he flew 40 missions in New Guinea, Western Pacific, Formosa, China, Okinawa and the Philippines and crash landed in the northern tip of Borneo. Bill received an Air Metal with Bronze Star, the Philippines Liberation Medal with Bronze Battle Star, American Theater Ribbon, American Theater Ribbon with Silver Battle Star, an Overseas Service Bar and Victory Metal.